

REHABILITATION PATHWAYS

COMMON CAREERS	EDUCATION	MEDIAN INCOME	HIGHLIGHTS
Physical/Occupational Therapy Aide - Assists Therapists and Assistants with patient therapy and evaluation - Maintains clean, safe environment - Clerical tasks (scheduling and billing support)	High School Diploma ↓ On-the-Job Traning (1 week - 1 month)	\$36k-40k/year	- Entry-level, can start working right away - Opportunity to continue education - Low stakes way to observe the field of Physical and Occupational Therapy!
Physical/Occupational Therapy Assistant - Performs delegated therapy procedures - Reports observations to physical therapist	Associate of Science Degree (2 years) ↓ National Physical Therapy Exam (NPTE) National Board for Certification in Occupational Therapy (NBCOT) Exam	\$64k-67k/year	- Go to school for 2 years and start earning income - Work directly with patients - In-demand job!
Physical Therapist - Diagnose patients' movements - Develop individualized plans of care for patients - Use exercises and other therapy techniques to ease patients' pain and help increase mobility	Bachelor of Science Degree (4 years) ↓ Doctor of Physical Therapy (DPT) Degree (+ 3 years) ↓ National Physical Therapy Exam (NPTE)	\$99k/year	- Increased income, more time invested in education - Opportunity to get advanced certifications - In-demand job!
Occupational Therapist - Develop treatment plans - Help clients relearn and perform daily living tasks, such as teaching a person who has had a stroke how to get dressed - Demonstrate exercises to help relieve clients' pain	Bachelor of Science Degree (4 years) ↓ Master of Science Degree in Occupational Therapy (+ 2-3 years) ↓ National Board for Certification in Occupational Therapy (NBCOT) Exam	\$96k/year	- Increased income, more time invested in education - Opportunity to get advanced certifications - In-demand job!

SOURCES:

AMERICAN PHYSICAL THERAPY ASSOCIATION, [HTTPS://WWW.APTA.ORG/](https://www.apta.org/)
AMERICAN BOARD OF PHYSICAL THERAPY RESIDENCY AND FELLOWSHIP EDUCATION, WWW.ABPTRFE.APTA.ORG/
AMERICAN OCCUPATIONAL THERAPY ASSOCIATION, "AOTA'S ADVANCED CERTIFICATION PROGRAM," WWW.AOTA.ORG/CAREER/ADVANCED-CERTIFICATION-PROGRAM
NATIONAL BOARD FOR CERTIFICATION IN OCCUPATIONAL THERAPY, WWW.NBCOT.ORG/
U.S. BUREAU OF LABOR STATISTICS "OCCUPATIONAL OUTLOOK HANDBOOK" WWW.BLS.GOV/OOH/HEALTHCARE/
WASHINGTON STATE DEPARTMENT OF HEALTH, "PHYSICAL THERAPIST AND PHYSICAL THERAPIST ASSISTANT," WWW.DOH.WA.GOV/

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